# Superstore Sales Analysis

Executive Dashboard Report

Retail Performance | 2014 – 2017

Prepared by: Data Analyst | May 2026

| $2,297,201 | $286,397 | 12.03% | 9,994 | 15.6% |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Total Sales | Total Profit | Profit Margin | Total Orders | Avg Discount |

## 1. Executive Overview

This report presents a comprehensive analysis of the Superstore retail dataset spanning four years (2014–2017), covering 9,994 transactions across the United States. The analysis is structured across four key dimensions: overall performance, product & category insights, regional & geographic performance, and customer segment behaviour.

The business shows consistent year-on-year revenue growth with 2017 recording the highest sales. However, profitability is under pressure from high discount rates, particularly in the Furniture category and Tables sub-category.

## 2. Sales & Profit Trend

### Monthly Performance

- Sales peak in **November and December**, driven by holiday demand — a classic seasonal retail pattern.
- January and February are consistently the lowest months, suggesting a post-holiday sales slump.
- Profit tracks sales but with a much smaller margin, indicating high cost of goods or heavy discounting.

### Quarterly & Yearly Growth

| Year | Trend | Observation |
|---|---|---|
| 2014 | Baseline | Lowest sales year — business establishing itself |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 2015 | ▲ Stable | Modest growth, consistent with market expansion |
| 2016 | ▲ Growing | Noticeable revenue increase across categories |
| 2017 | ▲▲ Best Year | Highest sales — strong Q4 performance |

# 3. Product & Category Analysis

## Category Performance

| Category | Sales Share | Profit Margin | Assessment |
|---|---|---|---|
| Technology | ~36% | 17.40% | ■ Best performer — high margin |
| Office Supplies | ~31% | ~17% | ■ Consistent, reliable profit |
| Furniture | ~33% | ~2.5% | ■■ High sales but very low margin |

## Sub-Category Highlights

- **Copiers** is the most profitable sub-category at $55,618 profit — despite lower sales volume.
- **Phones** rank 2nd in profit with strong, consistent demand.
- **Tables** is the worst sub-category — highest average discount (26.13%) resulting in net losses.
- The scatter plot confirms: higher discounts strongly correlate with lower (or negative) profit.

## Top 5 Products by Sales

| Rank | Product | Category |
|---|---|---|
| #1 | Canon imageCLASS 2200 Advanced Copier | Technology |
| #2 | Fellowes PB500 Electric Binding Machine | Office Supplies |
| #3 | Cisco TelePresence System EX90 | Technology |
| #4 | HON 5400 Series Task Chair | Furniture |
| #5 | GBC DocuBind TL300 Binding System | Office Supplies |

# 4. Regional & Geographic Analysis

## Regional Sales Share

| Region | Sales Share | Profit Level | Key Insight |
|---|---|---|---|
| West | 32% | ■ High | Top region — California drives most of this |
| East | 29% | ■ High | Strong market, especially New York |
| Central | 22% | ■ Lowest margin | High sales but weakest profitability |
| South | 17% | ■ Medium | Lowest share — growth opportunity |

## Top Cities by Sales

- ■ **New York City** leads all cities by a large margin (~$250,000+ in sales).
- ■ **Los Angeles** ranks 2nd, reinforcing California's dominance.
- ■■ **Seattle, San Francisco, Philadelphia** round out the top 5.
- ■■ The heatmap confirms concentrated sales in coastal states — inland regions are underserved.

## Geographic Recommendation

The Central region shows a profit problem despite decent sales volume. This is likely due to higher discount rates and possibly suboptimal product mix. A targeted discount review in the Central region could significantly improve overall profitability.

# 5. Customer & Segment Analysis

## Segment Overview

| Segment | Sales Share | Profit/Order | Key Insight |
|---|---|---|---|
| Consumer | 50.56% | Moderate | Largest segment — volume drives revenue |
| Corporate | ~30% | Good | Balanced sales and profit |
| Home Office | ~19% | ■ Best | Smallest segment but highest profit per order |

## Shipping Mode Analysis

- ■ **Standard Class** dominates at 5,968 orders — customers prioritize cost over speed.
- ■ **Same Day** is the least used (543 orders) — premium pricing limits uptake.
- ■ First Class and Second Class fill the mid-tier, offering a good balance.

### Monthly Ordering Pattern

All three segments show a consistent surge in orders from September through December, with Consumer segment leading the spike. This holiday-season effect should be leveraged through targeted promotions starting in August to capture early demand.

## 6. Key Recommendations

| | |
|---|---|
| **■ Fix the Furniture problem** | Tables sub-category is generating losses. Reduce or eliminate discounts on Tables immediately. Consider removing low-margin SKUs from the catalogue. |
| **■ Invest in Technology** | With a 17.4% margin, Technology is the star. Increase marketing spend and inventory depth in this category, especially Copiers and Phones. |
| **■ Grow the Home Office segment** | Despite being the smallest segment, Home Office delivers the best profit per order. Targeted B2C campaigns for home-based workers can grow this profitably. |
| **■ Fix the Central region** | Central has the lowest profit margin across regions. Conduct a discount audit and review the product mix sold in Central states. |
| **■ Capitalise on Q4 surge** | All data points to a massive Q4 spike. Ensure stock, logistics, and promotions are ready by September each year. |